BUILT ENVIRONMENT IMPACT BRIEF · BUILD PHILLY NOW

WHAT PA'S 2026 ELECTIONS MEAN FOR THE BUILT ENVIRONMENT

Housing + transit · November 2026 · PA housing & transit coalitions

PRELIMINARY — UNOFFICIAL RETURNS, HOUSE RACES STILL UNCALLED

THE HEADLINE

DEMOCRATS WON A TRIFECTA — AND FLIPPED THE SENATE

~108/203

STATE HOUSE — D

Held & expanded (from 103). 7 races uncalled.

26/50

STATE SENATE — D

Flipped from R 27–23. All 4 flips AP-called. First D majority since 1994.

3

BRANCHES ALIGNED

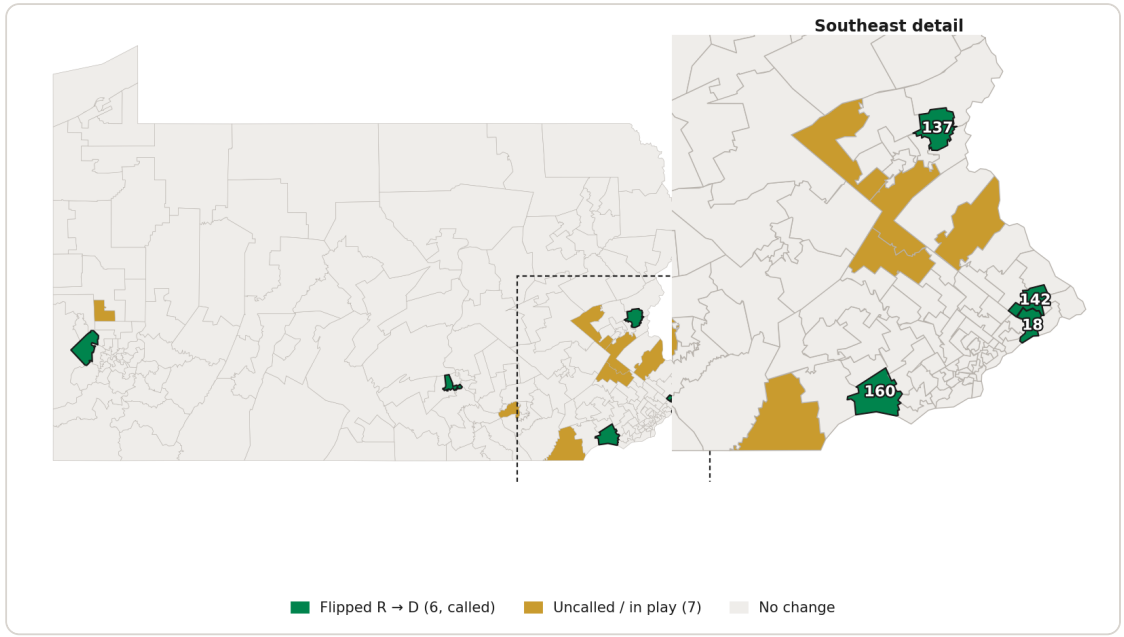
House + Senate + Shapiro. Bills can finally move through both chambers.



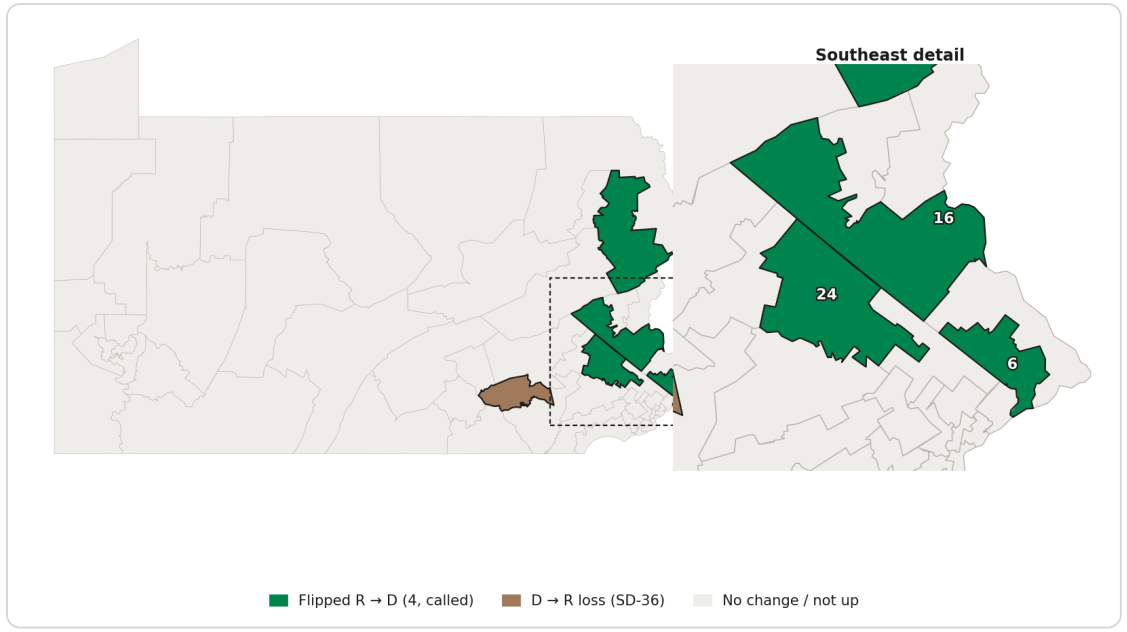
Why it matters: the House always passed these bills — they died in a Republican Senate. That wall is gone.

WHERE THE SEATS CHANGED HANDS

IT WAS THE SOUTHEAST SUBURBAN COLLAR



House — 6 flips, all R→D. Bucks, Delaware/Chester, Lehigh Valley, Cumberland, Allegheny.



Senate — the chamber flips. All 4 R→D called; SD-36 the lone D→R loss.

THE COST ON ZONING

WE LOST TWO REPUBLICAN CHAMPIONS

DISTRICT	MEMBER (LOST)	HB 2186 ADU	HB 2109 OCCUPANCY
HD-142	Joe Hogan	Yea	Yea
HD-137	Joe Emrick	Yea	Yea
HD-44	Valerie Gaydos	Yea	Yea

No assuming the newcomers. Their Democratic successors are unproven — none has voted on these bills. The honest read is a loss of two rock-solid R champions, not an automatic swap for new Yeas.

TRANSIT FUNDING

THE SAME WALL — NOW GONE

108–95

HB 1788 PASSED HOUSE

27–22

SENATE TABLED SAVAL'S FUNDING AMENDMENT

4

ANTI-TRANSIT SENATORS DEFEATED

Farry, Pennycuick, Coleman, Brown — all voted to table it.

But housing ≠ transit. Hogan was pro-both; Emrick & Gaydos pro-housing / anti-transit; Williams the reverse; incoming Tom Jones (SD-36) is pro-ADU but anti-transit.

WHAT CHANGES IN THE SENATE

NEW COMMITTEE GAVELS (LIKELY)

URBAN AFFAIRS & HOUSING

from Picozzi (R)

Nikil Saval (D)

LOCAL GOVERNMENT

from Keefer (R)

Patty Kim (D)

TRANSPORTATION

from Judy Ward (R)

Marty Flynn (D)

Not final. The Senate Democratic caucus doesn't assign committee chairs until it organizes in the new year. These are the likely incoming chairs — Saval notably authored both the housing coalition's case and the tabled transit amendment.

WHAT IT MEANS

THE CHOKEPOINT IS GONE. NOW THE WORK.

- **Both fights can move.** A D Senate + D House + Shapiro turns "passes the House, dies in the Senate" into bills that reach the desk.
- **Protect a thin majority & a thinner bipartisan bench.** We lost proven R champions; the new members are unproven — talk to them now.
- **Pick up where we can.** Tom Jones (SD-36) is a proven ADU vote; surviving Rs like Langerholc & Robinson sit on pro-reform delegations.
- **Mind the gaps.** Housing and transit aren't the same coalition — and the newcomers need a conversation, not an assumption.